
MARKET RESEARCH & STRATEGY

AI Safety Council

Market Opportunity & Go-to-Market Plan

Gap Analysis · Phased Rollout · Tiered Syllabus

Certified AI Practitioner for OSH (AI-OSH)

AI Safety Council — Market Opportunity & Go-to-Market Plan

What this document is: The case for the market opportunity, a phased plan for how to enter it with low risk, and the course structure that gets delivered along the way. **Date:** 02 July 2026

Disclaimer on numbers: All figures in this document — survey statistics, competitor pricing, lesson durations, enrollment/completion thresholds, and revenue assumptions — are estimates or planning simulations based on available research at the time of writing. They are meant to guide decision-making, not to be treated as guaranteed outcomes. Actual results, prices, and figures can and will vary, and several are explicitly flagged in Section 7 as unverified or in need of further research.

1. Executive Summary

There is a real, underserved gap in the market: nowhere in the world does a structured, multi-level "AI competency for safety professionals" program exist. Every competitor we found offers a single, standalone course — none take a learner from beginner through to leading AI adoption in their organization. That gap is even wider in our primary target audience — **Indian safety professionals working in or targeting jobs in the UAE and other GCC countries** — who are largely unreached by the handful of existing global competitors.

Rather than building the full platform first and hoping for an audience, we propose **proving the market cheaply before investing in it fully**: start with small, live-batch Zoom sessions for the entry-level course, build a lightweight website to support and extend that audience, and only then invest in the full self-serve learning platform — once real students and real revenue already exist.

2. Market Opportunity (Gap Analysis)

2.1 The demand is real, and it's confirmed by the industry's own bodies

- The **American Society of Safety Professionals (ASSP)** — the largest safety professional body in the US — approved an official AI position statement in September 2024, and published an AI Task Force white paper in February 2026 stating plainly that *"many OSH professionals report they lack knowledge about AI and its implications, creating a need for increased education and awareness."* They named **AI competency development** as one of five pillars of their own strategy.
- A survey of 1,053 EHS/safety professionals (National Safety Council + Wolters Kluwer, published April 2026) found only **~20% use AI extensively** in their work, while **62% use it only moderately or minimally** — a large, addressable group that's aware of AI but not yet confident using it.

(Honest caveat: no source anywhere puts a dollar figure on the size of this market. The evidence here is about confirmed demand and a confirmed knowledge gap, not a market-size estimate — we're not going to invent one.)

2.2 The competition is real, but nobody has done what we're proposing

We found at least six existing "AI for safety professionals" courses globally:

Provider	Format	Price	Level
AIHA / University of Illinois Chicago	40-hour project-based course (or half-day workshop)	Not published	Hands-on practitioners only — explicitly excludes leadership
Phoenix Health & Safety (UK)	18-hour self-paced, NEBOSH-verified	£415	All levels, single course
M3 International (Singapore)	8-hour live session	S\$390	HSE practitioners
Alison	Free, self-paced	Free	Beginner
Udemy	Self-paced	Standard pricing	Practitioners
The Knowledge Academy	1-day, 3 delivery formats	\$1,995	Managers/specialists

Every one of these is a single, standalone course. Not one of them offers a graduated pathway from beginner to leadership. Even the most rigorous option (AIHA/UIC's 40-hour program) **explicitly states it is not for executives or leadership** — that audience is left completely unserved, everywhere, by everyone.

2.3 The India → GCC angle is where the real opening is

None of the six competitors above are positioned for, or realistically visible to, our specific target audience — **Indian safety professionals building a career in the UAE and GCC**. That audience already has a well-established, decades-old behavior: paying for internationally-recognized certifications (NEBOSH, IOSH) specifically to qualify for Gulf safety jobs, marketed through Indian training centers, WhatsApp groups, and social media — channels the global competitors above don't use at all.

That means:

- **This specific audience is very unlikely to have encountered any of the six competitors.** The niche has some global competition, but our actual target market is close to untouched.
- **The buying behavior already exists** — we're adding a new, complementary credential into a purchase pattern people already follow, not creating a new one.
- **The ongoing safety-hiring demand in GCC construction, oil & gas, and infrastructure** keeps this audience actively investing in credentials that make them more employable.

(Honest caveat: we have no direct data yet on the size of the Indian HSE workforce in the GCC, on how GCC regulators or employers view a new, unaccredited certificate, or on real pricing sensitivity in this specific audience. These are flagged as open questions in Section 7, not assumed.)

2.4 What this means for positioning

We recommend **not** positioning this as competing with IOSH/NEBOSH. Those bodies have decades of employer trust that would be expensive and slow to fight for. Instead, position it as a **stackable, complementary skill credential**: *"You already have your NEBOSH/IOSH — now be the safety professional who's also AI-certified."* This borrows their credibility rather than competing with it, and matches the "transferable competency, not tool-dependence" idea at the heart of the course itself.

3. Target Market

- **Primary:** Indian safety professionals currently working, or actively seeking work, in the UAE and other GCC countries (construction, oil & gas, EPC contractors).
 - **Expansion path:** once proven, extend to the broader global safety-professional audience the six competitors are already (thinly) serving.
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4. Go-to-Market Strategy — A Phased, Low-Risk Rollout

Instead of building the full learning platform first and hoping for an audience, we propose proving demand in three phases — each one cheap to test, and nothing built along the way is thrown away.

Phase 0 — Live Zoom Batches (Foundation Course)

- Small, live-batch Zoom sessions delivering the **Foundation-tier course** (see Section 5).
- The teaching content is **AI-avatar-presented video, built from material written and reviewed by a real, credentialed expert** — disclosed as AI-assisted delivery, not a fabricated identity. This gives international production quality and consistency without any trust risk.
- Sold and enrolled **directly by the tutor** — no platform needed yet.
- Priced and paid **separately** from the future platform courses.
- Goal: get real, paying students in the door fast, and start collecting testimonials and proof of demand.

Phase 1 — Lightweight Marketing & Enrollment Website

Built in parallel or shortly after Phase 0 starts, this is a small, focused site — **not** the full learning platform:

- **Pages:** Home, About, Contact, Course Details — enough for a visitor to understand what's offered.
- **Enrollment:** a contact form that emails the tutor, who closes the sale directly (call/WhatsApp/payment link) — exactly how NEBOSH/IOSH coaching centers already sell to this audience.
- **Materials for Phase 0 graduates:** a simple, shared-password page where each batch can download recordings/worksheets — no individual accounts needed yet.
- Built on the same design template planned for the full platform later, so nothing here is wasted work.

Phase 2 — The Full Learning Platform

Once Phase 0/1 have proven real demand (see the thresholds proposed in Section 6), invest in the full self-serve platform — student logins, bulk course upload, the two assessment types, and automated certification — to deliver the **Practitioner, Professional, and Leadership & Trainer** tiers at scale. This is the platform already scoped and costed separately.

Why this sequencing matters: it turns "spend the full build budget before any student or any revenue exists" into "prove the market cheaply first, then invest in scale with confidence." It also means Phase 0's graduates become the full platform's first, warmest users when it launches.

5. The Product — Tiered Syllabus

The course is structured in four tiers, each building on the last — deliberately designed around the one gap no competitor fills: a real progression from beginner to organizational leadership.

Cross-Tier Summary

Tier	Certificate Awarded	Prerequisite	Total Duration	Assessment Types
1 — Foundation	Foundation Certificate in AI for OSH	None	~7 hrs	MCQ only
2 — Practitioner	Practitioner Certificate in AI for OSH	Tier 1	~11 hrs	MCQ + PDF upload
3 — Professional	Certified AI Practitioner for OSH (flagship)	Tier 2	~14.25 hrs	MCQ + PDF upload
4 — Leadership & Trainer	Certified AI Leader & Trainer for OSH	Tier 3	~8.25 hrs + 4–6 hr capstone	MCQ + PDF + Capstone

Assessment escalates deliberately: Tier 1 is quiz-only (low stakes, build confidence); PDF-graded work enters at Tier 2 once there's something real to submit; Tier 4 culminates in a full capstone project — mirroring the one thing competitors (AIHA/UIC) do well, but extending it to a leadership audience they explicitly exclude.

Tier 1 is the natural Phase 0 product — short, low-stakes, and requires the least production effort, making it the right course to prove demand with before committing to the full platform.

Tier 1 — Foundation (~7 hours, 8 lessons)

Target: entry-level officers, anyone with zero AI exposure. Goal: demystify AI, remove fear, no tool complexity yet.

#	Lesson	Duration	What it covers	Learning outcome
1	Welcome & Why AI Matters for Safety Professionals	30 min	The shift happening in HSE work; real time-saved examples; course roadmap	Understand why this course exists for <i>their</i> role specifically
2	What Is AI, Really?	60 min	History of AI, narrow vs. general AI, ML vs. generative AI, what an LLM actually is (plain terms)	Can explain AI in plain language without jargon
3	Meet the Major AI Tools	60 min	Orientation tour: ChatGPT, Claude, Gemini, Copilot, NotebookLM — what each is good at	Recognizes tool names and their rough use cases
4	Where AI Shows Up in Safety Work Today	45 min	Realistic current use cases — drafting, summarizing, trend-spotting — NOT replacing inspections/judgment	Can identify 3–4 legitimate uses in their own job
5	AI's Limits & Failure Modes	60 min	Hallucinations (with a concrete fabricated-regulation example), bias, outdated data	Can spot a plausible-but-wrong AI answer
6	Basic Ethics & Responsible Use Primer	45 min	Confidentiality (never paste confidential incident data into public tools), human validation as a rule	Follows basic safe-use rules unsupervised
7	Your First Guided AI Conversation (hands-on lab)	60 min	Guided exercise: summarize a sample safety bulletin, draft a toolbox-talk outline, in a sandboxed "AI Playground"	Completes a real task with AI, supervised
8	Foundation Wrap-Up & Quiz	30 min	Recap + MCQ assessment on terminology, limitations, ethics	Certified to progress to Practitioner

Tier 2 — Practitioner (~11 hours, 9 lessons)

Target: officers/engineers who'll use AI daily. Goal: hands-on competence on real HSE tasks.

#	Lesson	Duration	What it covers	Learning outcome
1	From Awareness to Action — Practitioner Roadmap	20 min	What changes at this tier; tier goals	Sets expectations for hands-on work
2	Prompt Basics: Structure That Works	75 min	Anatomy of a good prompt (context/task/format/constraints), few-shot prompting; rewrite 3 weak prompts into strong ones	Writes a clear, structured prompt unaided
3	AI-Assisted Incident Reporting	90 min	Drafting incident narratives from raw notes; AI-assisted RCA (5-Whys, fishbone) as a brainstorming partner — human verifies every causal claim; exercise on an anonymized sample incident	Produces a defensible AI-assisted incident report
4	AI-Assisted Risk Assessment & JSA Drafting	90 min	Drafting a first-pass JSA/risk assessment from a task description; critically reviewing AI output against real hazards it may miss; compare AI draft vs. instructor "gold" version	Catches what AI misses in a JSA
5	Toolbox Talks & Training Content at Scale	60 min	Generating toolbox-talk topics/scripts, adjusting reading level; multilingual safety communication with translation-accuracy checks	Produces localized safety content responsibly
6	Data & KPI Trend Analysis with AI	75 min	Feeding safety KPI data to AI for pattern-spotting (leading vs. lagging indicators); building trend summaries	Uses AI as an analysis assistant, not decision-maker
7	Building Your Personal Prompt Library	45 min	How to save, organize, and reuse prompts for recurring tasks; platform Prompt Library feature	Has a working personal prompt library
8	Practical Exercise: End-to-End Task	90 min	Combined exercise: raw incident → report + RCA + related toolbox talk	Demonstrates full-cycle competence
9	Practitioner Assessment	60 min	MCQ (best practice) + PDF upload of the end-to-end exercise for admin grading (non-blocking)	Certified to progress to Professional

Tier 3 — Professional (~14.25 hours, 9 lessons) — *flagship "Certified AI Practitioner for OSH" credential*

Target: HSE managers, consultants, auditors, trainers. Goal: governance-level competency and lifecycle-wide application.

#	Lesson	Duration	What it covers	Learning outcome
1	Responsible AI Deep-Dive	90 min	ASSP's four principles (Trust, Transparency, Equity, Privacy) applied to real HSE scenarios; legal responsibilities and liability if AI-assisted advice is wrong; human validation as a formal control	Applies a recognized governance framework, not just intuition
2	Advanced Prompt Engineering & Reusable Templates	90 min	Multi-step/chained prompts, role-based prompting, structured output formats; building a team-wide (not just personal) prompt library	Designs prompts other staff can reuse reliably
3	AI Across the Full Safety Lifecycle	120 min	Risk assessments, HAZOP, Bowtie, SOPs, incident investigation, CAPA, audits, inspections, emergency planning, compliance docs — where AI helps and where it must not be trusted; case walkthroughs on HAZOP, CAPA, and audits	Applies AI appropriately across the entire lifecycle, not just incident reports
4	AI Vendor & Tool Evaluation	75 min	Evaluating an AI tool/vendor for HSE use: data handling, hallucination risk, cost, integration; a practical evaluation checklist (downloadable)	Can assess a new AI tool before it's adopted
5	Building an Internal AI Usage Policy	90 min	Drafting a company AI policy: what's allowed, prohibited, escalation, review cadence; template + customization exercise	Produces a usable draft AI policy for their org
6	Governance, Compliance & Audit Trails	60 min	Keeping records of AI-assisted decisions for audits; aligning with ISO 45001 and similar frameworks	Understands what must be documented, and why
7	Case Studies & Peer Review	90 min	Real-world AI-in-HSE successes and failures; peer-review exercise critiquing an anonymized AI-assisted risk assessment	Can critically evaluate someone else's AI-assisted work
8	Professional Capstone Prep	60 min	Scoping the mini-project that feeds into Tier 4's full capstone	Has a scoped project ready for Tier 4
9	Professional Assessment	90 min	MCQ (governance/policy knowledge) + PDF upload (their AI usage policy draft or a lifecycle case-study analysis)	Certified to progress to Leadership & Trainer

Tier 4 — Leadership & Trainer (~8.25 hrs instruction + 4–6 hr capstone, 8 lessons)

Target: EHS leaders, department heads, trainers. Goal: lead org-wide adoption and train others — the gap no competitor fills.

#	Lesson	Duration	What it covers	Learning outcome
1	Leading AI Adoption — Change Management for Safety Teams	90 min	Why AI initiatives fail (resistance, unclear ROI, no governance); change-management frameworks applied to a safety department's AI rollout	Can lead an AI rollout without it stalling
2	Building Organization-Wide AI Governance	90 min	Scaling the Tier 3 policy into full governance: roles, committees, review cycles; aligning with legal/IT	Can stand up governance beyond a single team
3	Measuring ROI & Building the Business Case	75 min	Time-saved metrics, quality improvements, quantifying reduced admin burden; business-case template + exercise	Can pitch AI investment to leadership with numbers
4	Train-the-Trainer: Teaching AI Literacy to Your Team	90 min	Adult-learning principles for teaching AI to skeptical staff; structuring an internal workshop (using this course's own format as a model); practice: outline a 1-hour internal session	Can run their own internal AI training session
5	Leading Through Uncertainty — Staying Current	60 min	Keeping a team's competency current as tools evolve monthly; building an internal "AI champions" network	Has a plan to keep the team current long-term
6	Capstone Project: AI-Enabled Safety Improvement	4–6 hrs, self-paced over 2–4 weeks	Real project: pick a safety process in their own org, apply an AI-enabled improvement, document before/after, present results	Demonstrates full leadership-level competence on a real problem
7	Peer & Admin Review of Capstone	async	Admin reviews and grades the capstone submission (PDF upload)	—
8	Graduation & Certification	—	Final review; certificate issued	Earns "Certified AI Leader & Trainer for OSH" — top tier, LinkedIn-shareable

Why this tier matters most competitively: it's the one altitude where AIHA/UIC — the strongest existing competitor — explicitly says "not for you." Nobody else addresses it at all.

6. What "Proof" Looks Like Before Moving to Phase 2

Suggested thresholds to know when it's time to invest in the full platform — **these are starting proposals, not fixed targets; adjust to what feels right for the budget and risk appetite:**

Signal	Suggested threshold
Live batches run	At least 2–3 completed Foundation-tier batches
Paying students enrolled	At least 20–30 total across those batches
Completion rate	At least 70% of enrolled students finish the course
Testimonials / case studies collected	At least 5–10 usable, specific testimonials
Phase 0 revenue vs. cost	Phase 0 has at least broken even (tutor time + AI video production + Zoom costs covered)

Once these are met, there's real evidence — real students, real completion, real willingness to pay — to justify investing in the full platform rather than building on assumption alone.

7. Risks & Honest Caveats

- **No market-size figure (TAM/SAM) exists** for AI-OSH training specifically, globally or in India/GCC — only adoption-rate and sentiment data. Don't present a dollar-value market size as fact.
- **No public enrollment numbers exist for any of the six competitors** — their popularity/traction is unknown, not zero.
- **GCC-specific data is currently unverified**: we don't yet know the size of the Indian HSE workforce in the Gulf, how GCC safety regulators or major employers view a new, unaccredited certificate, or real price sensitivity in this exact audience. These can be researched further if useful before finalizing the pitch.
- **Vendor pricing for the six competitors (£415, S\$390, \$1,995, etc.) moves over time** — treat as directional, re-check before quoting directly to a client or investor.
- **The Udemy competitor's exact curriculum wording** was sourced from search snippets, not a direct page fetch (Udemy blocks scraping) — spot-check before quoting it verbatim.

8. Recommendation & Next Steps

1. **Proceed with the phased approach** — it materially reduces risk by proving demand before the full platform investment.
2. **Position as a stackable credential alongside IOSH/NEBOSH**, not a competitor to them.
3. **Start Phase 0 (Zoom batches) as soon as the Foundation-tier content and AI-avatar video are ready** — this is the fastest path to real revenue and real proof.
4. **Build Phase 1 (lightweight site) in parallel** so Phase 0 graduates have somewhere to land and the audience keeps growing.
5. **Hold Phase 2 (full platform) until the thresholds in Section 6 are met** — or are consciously adjusted and accepted as sufficient.
6. **If useful, commission a follow-up research pass** specifically on India/GCC workforce size, GCC regulatory stance on AI, and competitor visibility in that market, to firm up Section 2.3 further before this goes in front of the client.

